

The single brand crossover

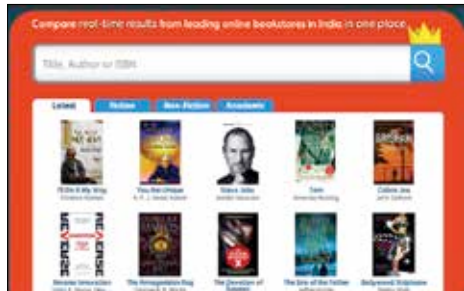
This is another popular model used mainly by established individual retail brands to not only create awareness about the brand and product but also drive sales. With this model, brands are able to expand their brick store into a click store, thereby, reaching out to a wider audience than what may have been possible with solely the physical store.

In this day and age there are a multitude of stores that have adopted this model ranging from airlines that sell tickets for their flights, artists that sell their own music, authors that sell their own books, physical grocery stores that can now take orders online, pizza outlets that urge you to order through their site – there is a store for just about anything you can think of. There are also luxury stores that are adopting this concept in reverse. Luxury e-commerce jewelry stores have in some cases created experience lounges so that their customers are able to touch and feel the jewelry before going back online and purchasing it. Here, having a brick store has enabled them to add credibility to their e-commerce site and reduced the perceived risk of shopping high-value luxury items online.

The bricks and clicks model is more easily adopted by a traditional retailer than for a start-up company as the control of costs and logistics required for the model to succeed. Harvard Business Review states that the key factor for a bricks and clicks model to be

successful, “will, to a large extent, be determined by a company’s ability to manage the trade-offs between separation and integration of their retail and online businesses.

When e-commerce was first born, analysts argued that their success would render traditional retail stores obsolete. Instead, the bricks and clicks model has enabled such businesses to thrive even further and create a stronger brand identity.



Models of the future

The above is by far not an exhaustive list of the e-commerce business